

XV.
Popish Minstres,
the shall not be
imported or
planted; Penalty,
one mark.

Justices of Peace
may search for,
and seize and
destroy, Popish
Books, Bibles, &c.

And be it further enacted by the Authority of this present Parliament, That no person or persons shall bring from beyond the Seas, nor shall print sell or buy any Popish Primers Ladies Psalters Manuals Romish Popish Catechismes Minstres Breviaries Portals Legendes and Lives of Saints, containing superstitious matter, printed or written in any Language whatsoever, nor any other superstitious Bookes printed or written in the English Tongue, upon paine of Forfeiture of Forty Shillinges for every such Bookes; One third part thereof to be to the King's Majesty his Heires and Successors, one other third part to him that will sue for the same, and the other third part to the Poore of the Parish where such Bookes or Bookes shalbe found, to be recovered by Acton of Debt Bill Plaint or Informacion in any of the King's Majesties Court of Recorde, wherein no Escoyne Proteccion or Wager of Lawe shalbe admitted or allowed, and the said Bookes to be burned: And that it shall be lawfull for any two Justices of Peace within the Limites of their Jurisdiction or Authority, and to all Mayors Bayliffs and Chiefe Officers of Cities and Townes Corporate in their Liberties, from tyme to tyme to search the Houses and Lodgings of every Popish Recusant convict or of every person whose Wife is or shall be a Popish Recusant convict, for Popish Bookes and Reliques of Popery; And that if any Alter Pix Boudes Pictures or such like Popish Reliques or any Popish Bookes or Bookes shall be found in their or any of their Custodie, as in the opinion of the said Justices Mayor Bayliffe or Chiefe Officer as aforesaid shall be thought meete for such Recusant as aforesaid to have or use, the same shall be openly defaced and burnt, if it be meete to be burned; And if it be a Crucifix or other Relique of any price, the same to be defaced at the Ocell Quarter Sessions of the Peace in the County where the same shall be found, and the same soe defaced to be restored to the Owner againe.

XVI.
Armes, &c. (except
for necessary
Defence) of Popish
Recusants convict
shall be seized by
Justices of Peace.

And be it also enacted by the Authority aforesaid, That all such Armour Gunpowder and Munition of whatsoever kind as any Popish Recusant convict within this Realme of England hath or shall have in his House or Houses or elsewhere, or in the Hande or Possession of any other at his or their disposicion, shalbe taken from such Popish Recusant or others which have or shall have the same to the use of such Popish Recusant, by Warrant of Four Justices of Peace, at their Ocell or Quarter Sessions to be holden in the same County where such Popish Recusant shalbe resident; (other then such necessary Weapons as shalbe thought fit by the said Four Justices of Peace to remaine and be allowed for the Defense of the person or persons of such Recusant, or for the Defense of his her or their House or Houses); And that the said Armour and Munition so taken shalbe kept and maintained at the Cost of such Recusant in such Place as the said Four Justices of Peace at their said Sessions of the Peace shall see downe and appointe.

XVII.
Penalty on any
disturbing or
obstructing Armours
Impment, &c.

And be it further enacted by the Authority aforesaid, That if any such Recusant having or which shall have any such Armour Gunpowder and Munition or any of them, or if any other person or persons which shall have any such Armour Gunpowder and Munition or any of them to the use of any such Recusant, shall refuse to declare or manifest unto the said Justices of Peace or any of them what Armour he shalbe or they have or shall have, or shall 'at hinder or disturbe the delivery thereof to any of the said Justices or to any other person or persons authorised by their Warrant to take and seize the same, then every such person so offending contrary to this Statute in this behalf shall forfeit his home to the King's Majesty his Heires & Successors his & their said Armour Gunpowder and Munition, and shall also be imprisoned by Warrant of or from any Justice of the Peace of such County by the space of Three Months without Baile or Mainprize.

XVIII.
Armes, &c. shall be
kept and reserved
at Request of
Recusant.

And yet nevertheless be it enacted by the Authority aforesaid, That notwithstanding the taking away of such Armour Gunpowder and Munition, the said Popish Recusant shall and may be charged with the maintaining of the same, & with the buying gridding & maintaining of Horses & other Armour and Munition, in such sort as other his Majesties Subjectes from tyme to tyme shalbe appointed and commanded, according to their several Abillities and Qualities; And that the said Armour and Munition at the Charge of such Popish Recusant for them and as their owne provision of Armour and Munition, shalbe shewed at every Muster Show or Use of Armour to be had or made within the said County.

XIX.
Penalty for
obstructed
Comme.

Provided always, That nothing this Acte nor any thing therein contained shall extend to take away or shalbe the Authority or Jurisdiction of the Ecclesiasticall Consens, for any Cause or Matter; but that the Chancellours of his Majesties his Heires and Successors in causes Ecclesiasticall for the tyme being Archbishops Bishops and other Ecclesiasticall Judges may doe and provide as before the making of this Acte they lawfully did or might have done; Any thing in this Acte to the contrary in any wise notwithstanding.